Write it *right.*

Steps, phrases and checks for the email, the article and the story.

Two tasks · 45 minutes · about 100 words each

THE PAPER AT A GLANCE

No. 02

Two tasks, one pen, forty-five minutes

2
tasks: an email, then an article or a story

45
minutes: about 20 for each task, then check

100
words, more or less, for each task

40
marks in total, 20 for each task

Part 1, the email, is for everyone. In Part 2 you choose: an article or a story.

HOW YOU ARE MARKED

No. 03

Four things the examiner reads for

0–5 MARKS

Content

Did you answer everything? Every note, every question, nothing off topic.

0–5 MARKS

Communicative Achievement

The right format and tone: *Hi Sam* for a friend, *Dear Mr Lee* for a teacher.

0–5 MARKS

Organisation

Paragraphs and linking words that lead the reader from one idea to the next.

0–5 MARKS

Language

Different words, not the same ones again, and some longer sentences.

Reply to every note

1. Read the email: who wrote it, and what do they want?
2. Find the four notes. Each one needs a full answer.
3. Plan one short paragraph for each note.
4. Open and close: *Hi Jude,* … *See you soon,* and your name.
5. Add a reason or an example to every note.
6. Tick the notes, count the words, check the spelling.

From: Jude · Subject: Our class trip

Our class trip is next month!

Me too!

Should we go by bus or by train?

Explain which is better

What should we take with us?

Suggest…

Can you help with the food on Saturday?

No, because…

Phrases that do the work

Suggesting

- How about + -ing?
- Why don't we...?
- Let's...
- Shall we...?

Preferring

- I'd rather...
- I prefer X to Y.
- I'm not keen on...
- X is better because...

Reasons

- because + verb
- as / since + verb
- because of + noun
- in case...

Open & close

- Hi Sam,
- Thanks for your email!
- See you soon,
- Best wishes,

Use your own words. Don't copy sentences from the email you received.

What a good reply looks like

Hi Jude,

Thanks for your email! I'd love to come on the trip too. I've never been to the mountains, so I'm really excited.

I think the train is better than the bus because it's faster and more comfortable. We can walk around, and the views from the window are amazing.

How about taking sandwiches and a warm jacket? It might be cold in the evening.

I'm sorry, but I can't help with the food on Saturday because I have a football match. Maybe Ana can do it?

See you soon,

Maria

01

Greeting, closing and name on their own lines.

02

One short paragraph for each note.

03

A reason or a detail in every answer.

04

About 100 words, and no note missing.

PART 2 *No. 07*

Article *or* story.

You choose one. About 100 words. Twenty marks.

Say what you think, and why

1. Underline every question in the notice. Answer them all.
2. Give a clear opinion: *In my opinion…*, *I believe…*
3. Back up each point with a reason and an example.
4. Use your own experience. It makes ideas easier to find.
5. Use your own words, not the words in the question.
6. Add a title, talk to the reader, end with your opinion.

THE FORMULA

Opinion
I think… / In my opinion…

+ Reason
because… / so…

+ Example
for example… / such as…

Their first line, your story

1. Copy the first sentence exactly. Keep the same *I* or *he/she*.
2. Plan three moments: the start, the problem, the ending.
3. Show feelings: how does the main character feel?
4. Link ideas: *when, as soon as, suddenly, in the end*.
5. Choose interesting words and, if you can, a surprise ending.

Three past tenses

PAST SIMPLE · EVENTS

I opened the door.

PAST CONTINUOUS · BACKGROUND

It was raining hard.

PAST PERFECT · BEFORE THAT

Someone had left a note.

Pick the one you can write best

Choose the *article* if…

- you like giving your opinion
- you know words for the topic
- you can think of reasons and examples quickly

Choose the *story* if…

- you are confident with past tenses
- an ending comes to you quickly
- you can describe how people feel

Practise both. Decide on the day, when you see the two tasks.

BEFORE YOU FINISH

No. 11

The five-minute check

- Every note or question answered
- Greeting and closing on their own lines
- Verb tenses, especially past forms
- Paragraphs, one idea in each
- Linking words: *because, so, however, then*
- About 100 words, spelling checked

Write in pen, clearly. The examiner can only mark what they can read.

Every note. Every question. About 100 words.

Good luck in the exam.